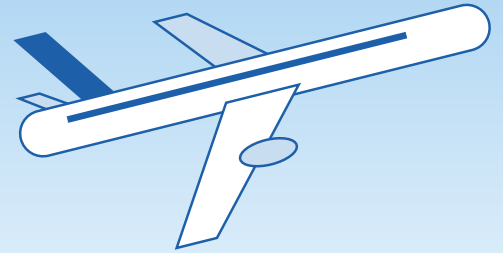


BOEING

PROGRAM REPORT / SEPTEMBER 2026

Boeing 797 Program Report



The gap. The balance sheet. The timeline.

Market case, design options, financial capacity and risk.

STATUS: STUDY PHASE, NOT LAUNCHED

LAUNCH WINDOW: ~2030 (REPORTED)

ENTRY INTO SERVICE: MID-2030s+

\$715B

record Boeing backlog (Q2 2026), including 6,200+ commercial airplanes

~2030

when CEO Kelly Ortberg says Boeing could be ready to fund a clean-sheet jet

"797" is an unofficial name: Boeing has not launched, named or announced this aircraft. Compiled from public reports and filings. Not investment advice.

PROGRAM SNAPSHOT

Where the "797" stands today, and what is and is not confirmed

None

LAUNCHED PROGRAM (STUDY PHASE ONLY)

~2030

REPORTED LAUNCH WINDOW

Mid-2030s+

REPORTED ENTRY INTO SERVICE

\$715B

BOEING TOTAL BACKLOG (Q2 2026)

\$0.6B

Q2 2026 FREE CASH FLOW

\$45.9B

CONSOLIDATED DEBT (Q2 2026)

WHAT IS CONFIRMED

Boeing has begun early design work and is "evaluating trade studies"; there is "no firm configuration" (CEO Kelly Ortberg, Jul. 2026).

Three gates before launch: Boeing financially ready, technology ready, and sufficient market demand.

Ortberg says Boeing could be ready to fund a clean-sheet program by about 2030, once the 737 MAX 7 / MAX 10 and 777-9 are certified.

The 2024 union contract states that the Puget Sound workforce will build Boeing's "next new airplane".

WHAT IS NOT CONFIRMED

The name "797": Boeing has never used it officially.

Size, range, seating, single- vs. twin-aisle layout, engines.

Development cost, launch customers, price, first flight or delivery dates.

Whether the next program is a midsize twin-aisle or a larger single-aisle 737 successor (see section 03).

MARKET BACKDROP

The global commercial backlog reached about 18,100 aircraft in May 2026. Airbus' A320neo family is reportedly sold out at its planned rate of 75 per month through 2032, and the A321neo dominates the upper single-aisle segment that a new Boeing jet would target.

PROGRAM HISTORY

From the New Midsize Airplane (NMA) to a "next new airplane"

2015

Boeing concludes the market is large enough for a new design between the 737 and 787; the project becomes the NMA, informally the "797".

2016-17

Options weighed: a stretched 737 MAX or an all-new design. Concept: composites, 777 / 787 technology, new ~50,000 lbf-class engines. Cost estimates reached ~\$15B.

2019-20

After the 737 MAX crashes, Boeing shelves the NMA to protect cash and engineering capacity.

2022

Then-CEO David Calhoun says the technology for the next airplane needs more time.

Jan. 2024

Door-plug blowout on a 737 MAX 9 triggers FAA production limits and a quality reset.

Aug. 2024

Kelly Ortberg becomes CEO and ends the X-66A truss-braced-wing demonstrator, keeping NASA wing research going.

Nov. 2024

Machinists' contract commits Puget Sound to build Boeing's "next new airplane", widely read as the 797.

May 2026

Bloomberg: studies intensify; preparatory work with suppliers expected in 2027; launch around end of decade.

Jul. 2026

At Farnborough, Ortberg says finances must be repaired first ("a couple more years"); airlines want current jets fixed first.

WHAT THE AIRCRAFT COULD BE

Two different concepts share the "797" label

Feature	Classic NMA / 797 concept (2015-20)	Reported 2026 study
Segment	Between 757 and 767: two versions, ~225 seats at 5,000 nmi and ~275 seats at 4,500 nmi	Upper single-aisle, starting near the 737 MAX 10 and growing into variants; possible 737 successor
Cabin	Twin-aisle, seven-abreast like the 767; usable on 7,000 ft runways such as LaGuardia	Conventional tube-and-wing; details unconfirmed
Structure	Composite fuselage and wings	Thinner, longer wings with 777X-style folding tips
Propulsion	New ~50,000 lbf-class turbofans (Pratt & Whitney or CFM / GE)	Ducted turbofans, possibly RISE-derived; little interest in open-fan; small tail auxiliary engine studied
Other	Timeline set by 737 MAX recovery	Redesigned cockpit; lower-risk technologies; truss-braced wing de-emphasized

READING THE SHIFT

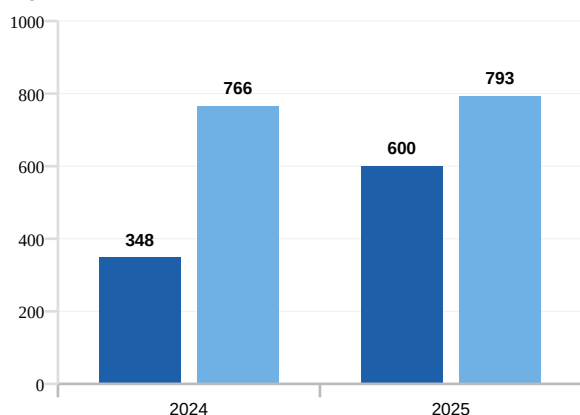
Older coverage describes a midsize twin-aisle that would replace the 757 and 767. The 2026 reporting describes something closer to a 737 successor aimed at the A321neo. Both are "unofficial 797" stories, so check which concept a given source means.

MARKET CASE

Why a gap exists and who is filling it

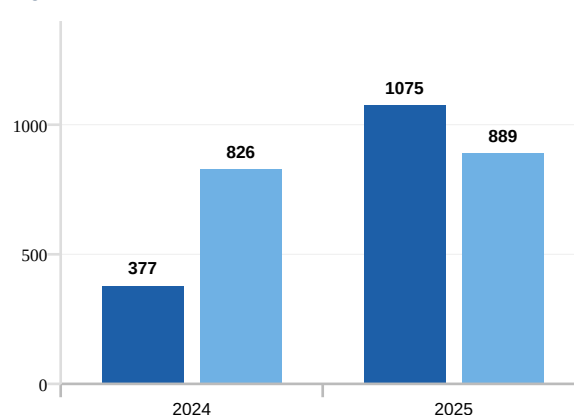
Deliveries (aircraft)

Boeing vs. Airbus, 2024 vs. 2025



Net orders (aircraft)

Boeing vs. Airbus, 2024 vs. 2025



Dark blue: Boeing (first bar in each pair). Light blue: Airbus (second bar). Boeing figures: 348 / 600 deliveries, 377 / 1,075 net orders. Airbus: 766 / 793 deliveries, 826 / 889 orders.

THE GAP

The 757 ended production in 2004 and the 767 is a legacy design, so no Boeing jet sits between the 737 MAX and the 787.

The Airbus A321XLR (EASA-certified Jul. 2024) is winning 757 replacement orders; Icelandair is one example.

Airlines have drifted toward larger single-aisles; the smallest variants (737 MAX 7, A319neo) sell poorly.

THE COUNTER-ARGUMENT

Airbus has argued since 2016 that the A321neo already serves the middle of the market.

Airlines are telling Boeing to fix delivery reliability first; "orders are not our challenge" (Ortberg).

JetZero (blended-wing body, ~250 passengers) targets the same segment, though far from certification.

WHY TIMING MATTERS

A late entrant loses share while Airbus fills its production slots into the 2030s. Any Boeing entry is unlikely before the mid-to-late 2030s, so the key question is whether the A321 family is still the benchmark by then.

FINANCIAL CAPACITY

Can Boeing fund a clean-sheet jet, and when?

Metric (Q2 2026)	Value	Context
Revenue	\$24.6B	+8% YoY; 171 commercial deliveries, highest quarter since 2018
Net loss	\$428M	vs. \$612M loss in Q2 2025; GAAP EPS -\$0.67
Free cash flow	\$631M	vs. -\$200M a year earlier; helped by receipt timing
2026 FCF guidance	\$1-3B	Includes a \$700M DOJ payment; Q3 guided to low hundreds of millions
Backlog	\$715B	Record; commercial unit \$597B; 6,200+ airplanes
Cash / debt	~\$20B / \$45.9B	Debt was \$47.2B at end of Q1
Commercial margin	-2.7%	Boeing Commercial Airplanes on \$11.8B revenue
737 rate	47 / month	Next step 52; supply-chain strain expected above 52

WHAT A LAUNCH NEEDS

The ~\$15B development estimate dates from 2015-16 and is not a current Boeing figure. No up-to-date cost has been disclosed.

Management calls a \$10B annual free-cash-flow level "very attainable", but no date is given, and 2027 cash flow is unquantified.

PREREQUISITES IN PROGRESS

737-7 and 737-10: certification flight testing complete (Jul. 2026); final FAA approval pending.

777-9: FAA approved certification flight testing in Q2 2026; still in the process.

Engineers are still tied up on these programs; Ortberg says the new jet waits until they mature.

TIMELINE & LAUNCH GATES

Reported milestones, and how sources disagree

Period	Milestone	Source
2026	Trade studies; no firm configuration	Ortberg, WSJ (Jul.)
2027	Preparatory work with suppliers expected to begin	Bloomberg (May)
~2030	Boeing ready to fund a clean-sheet program; launch around end of decade	FT interview; Bloomberg
Mid-2030s	Entry into service (May report)	Bloomberg (May)
End of 2030s	Jet "likely coming" by end of next decade (July report)	Bloomberg (Jul.)

ANALYST READING

The reported entry-into-service estimates span roughly the mid-2030s to the end of the 2030s. The wide range reflects that the launch decision itself depends on 737 and 777X certification, cash flow and the state of engine technology, none of which is settled.

RISKS & COMPETITION

The analyst checklist: what could accelerate or derail the program

ENABLERS

- Certification of 737-7, 737-10 and 777-9
- Rising 737 output and free cash flow
- Record \$715B backlog and strong order intake
- Mature, lower-risk technology set
- Supplier and engine partner alignment
- Puget Sound labor commitment

RISKS & THREATS

- Balance sheet still carrying \$45.9B of debt
- Commercial unit still loss-making
- Supply-chain limits above 52 per month on 737
- Engineering bandwidth split across programs
- Technology not yet ready (engines, wing)
- Airbus locking in A321 demand into the 2030s
- Regulatory and quality scrutiny after 2024

COMPETITIVE LANDSCAPE

Competitor	Position (as reported)
Airbus A321neo / XLR	Dominant upper single-aisle; A320 family sold out at rate 75 through 2032; XLR replacing 757s.
Airbus next generation	Backs open-fan technology (CFM RISE) as a future path; Boeing reportedly prefers ducted fans.
JetZero	Blended-wing-body concept for ~250 passengers targeting the midmarket; early stage.
Boeing 787 / 737 MAX 10	Neighbours in the lineup: the 797 would sit between the MAX 10 and the 787.

CONCLUSION

A real market gap, but a program that depends on Boeing's recovery

BOTTOM LINE

The "Boeing 797" is a study, not a program: Boeing has a plausible market gap to address and a record backlog, but no configuration, no launch date and no funding decision.

Cash flow is turning positive and deliveries are recovering, yet the commercial unit still loses money, debt is \$45.9B and three certification programs must finish first. Reported timelines put launch near the end of the decade and service entry from the mid-2030s. Airbus meanwhile has its A321 family sold out into the 2030s.

Key items to watch: 737-7 / 737-10 and 777-9 certification, free cash flow versus the \$1-3B guidance, 737 rate 52, supplier and engine announcements, and any first official naming or configuration.

READER NOTE

Compiled from Boeing's Q2 2026 results release, executive comments at the July 2026 Farnborough Airshow (CNBC, WSJ, Bloomberg), Bloomberg's May 2026 report as relayed by Air Data News, Leeham News, and general aviation references. Historical NMA specifications and the ~\$15B cost estimate are from 2015-2017 coverage and are not current. Sources sometimes disagree on timing. Nothing here is a Boeing statement about a "797". Not investment advice.